PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
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Dear POA colleagues,

As we transition to a work-from-home environment, the Finance Team would like to share with you the following important updates regarding changes to our processing techniques.

Payment Processing

Checks

Effective March 16, 2020, Partners of the Americas will process all payments electronically. We will no longer be making payments via check to vendors, employees, volunteers, contractors, etc. All payments will be processed electronically via ACH (domestic payments) or Wire (international payments). Please contact your vendors, volunteers, contractors, etc., that are currently paid by check to advise them of this change and request that they provide their ACH banking information instead. Please see ACH letter from the CFO attached.

ACH and Wire Transfers

All payment requests should be submitted **electronically** to the following directory:

C:\Partners of the Americas\F&A – Organizational F&A\Finance Payment Requests

Within this folder, there are subfolders:

- One for each program unit (CPU, EDH, EGC)
- Membership
- BizDev & Comm
- Admin, HR & IT.

Please submit signed payment request form and its supporting documents into the corresponding program/unit folder. We accept electronic signatures as well as e-mail authorized requests.

We advise that you **create a subfolder for each individual request**. This will help us determine which supporting documents belong to which signed payment request form. We strongly recommend that you please submit one PDF file which includes the payment request form and supporting documents other than saving multiple files to the subfolder.

We also advise that the following naming convention be used for your submission subfolder or PDF file:

Unit name - Payment Type - Brief name of recipient – year-month-month day to be processed.

For example: *"**CPU Wire Bejarano 2020-03-31**" or "**Admin ACH Keystone 2020-03-31**"*

Finance will stop retrieving submitted payment requests from the above folders after the 8:00 AM cutoff time for processing as shown on our payment calendar. Any submitted requests received after the cutoff time will be processed in the next disbursement cycle (please refer to the current payment calendar for more information).

Credit Cards

All current credit card holders will continue to receive their monthly statements by email.

All credit card statements from staff should be submitted **electronically** to the following directory:

C:\Partners of the Americas\F&A – Organizational F&A\Finance Credit Card Submissions

Within this folder, we will create subfolders for each staff to submit their credit card statements. Please submit your cover sheet (signed by both submitter and approver), excel file of the cover sheet, and its supporting documents in your appropriate subfolder.

Once submitted, please send an email notification to the Finance team.

Requests for Funding

Requests for funding should be submitted **electronically** to the following directory:

C:\Partners of the Americas\F&A – Organizational F&A\Finance Funding Requests

Within this folder, there are monthly subfolders. Please submit signed funding request form and its supporting documents into the corresponding folder. Only electronic signatures are accepted for this type of transaction.

We advise that you **create a subfolder for each individual request**. This will help us determine which supporting documents belong to which project. We strongly recommend that you please submit one PDF file which includes the funding request form and supporting documents other than saving multiple files to the subfolder.

We also advise that the following naming convention be used for your submission subfolder or PDF file:

Project code - year - month.

For example: *"**DOL419 2020-04**" or "**USAID619 2020-05**"*

As a reminder, requests for funding are due to the Finance team on the 21st of each month.

Establishing these new techniques will enable us to continue processing all payments according to our long-established procedures at this critical time. Going forward we will be adopting this new e-submission process for all payments, credit card submissions, and funding requests. This approach will

help to reduce our dependency on paper documents and contribute to meeting our organizational sustainability goals.

We understand that there may be questions regarding the new changes to our processing techniques, so please do not hesitate to reach out to the Finance Team with any questions that you may have.

Thank you for your cooperation and understanding.